ENG504 SHORT HANDOUTS MIDTERM

Lesson 06 to 10

(ENG504) Second Language Acquisition

EFFORT BY VUHELPERS24 TEAM

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Lesson-06

BEHAVIOURISM AND FIRST LANGUAGE ACQUISITION

Topic 032 - Behaviorism:

How do behaviorists view language learning?

Behaviorists view language learning as the formation of habits through stimulus-response pairing and reinforcement.

What is the process of first language acquisition according to behaviorism?

First language acquisition is seen as the learning of a new set of habits.

What are the implications of the behaviorist approach for teachers?

From a teacher's perspective, the behaviorist approach has two significant implications. First, learning primarily takes place through imitation and repetition, emphasizing that practice leads to improvement. Second, teachers should concentrate their teaching efforts on structures that are perceived as difficult,

particularly those areas where differences exist between the first and second languages.

Topic 033 - Behaviourism under Attack:

Who criticized behaviorism in the field of linguistics in the late 1950s?

Noam Chomsky criticized behaviorism in the late 1950s.

Why did Chomsky reject Skinner's behaviorist views?

Chomsky rejected Skinner's behaviorist views because he believed that children have an innate faculty that guides their language learning.

What key criticisms did Noam Chomsky level against behaviorism in language acquisition?

Chomsky strongly criticized behaviorist views on several fronts. He rejected the idea that one could compare the learning behaviors of laboratory rats performing simple tasks to the language acquisition process in children without direct teaching. Chomsky argued that children have an innate faculty that guides them in their language learning journey, undermining the behaviorist perspective.

Topic 034 - First Language Acquisition: Same Stages:

What did researchers in the 1970s find about language learning behavior in young children?

Researchers found striking similarities in language learning behavior among young children, regardless of the language they were learning.

Is there a consistent order of language structure acquisition among children worldwide?

Yes, there is a consistent order of language structure acquisition among children worldwide.

Topic 035 - First Language Acquisition: Similar Order:

When do children typically acquire the ability to form negative sentences?

Children all over the world acquire the ability to form negative sentences around the same age.

What did the research reveal about how children mark negative sentences in different languages?

Research showed that children mark negative sentences in similar ways in all languages.

What is the significant finding related to the rule-governed nature of child language?

One crucial finding is that child language is rule-governed. Even though initially the rules they create may not correspond to those of adults, children consistently express relationships between elements in sentences in a systematic way.

Topic 036 - First Language Acquisition: Negatives:

What is the important finding regarding the rule-governed nature of child language?

Child language is rule-governed, even if initially the rules they create do not correspond to adult language rules.

How do children eventually acquire broad exceptions to rules in language?

Children extract rules from the language they hear and apply them to their own production, including handling broad exceptions to rules at a later stage.

Can you explain the concept of children "extracting rules" from the language they hear?

Extracting rules means that children analyze the language they are exposed to, derive grammatical rules from that analysis, and apply these rules to their own speech and communication.

Topic 037 - First Language Acquisition: Rule Governed:

What is meant by children "extracting rules" from the language they hear?

It means that children analyze the language they are exposed to, derive grammatical rules, and apply these rules to their own speech.

At what point do children become able to handle broad exceptions to rules in language?

Children become able to handle broad exceptions to rules at a later stage in their language development.

Lesson 07

SECOND LANGUAGE LEARNING AND KRASHEN'S MONITOR MODEL

Topic No: 039-044 - Second Language Learning and Krashen's Monitor Model

What are some general principles of first language acquisition in children?

Children go through stages.

These stages are similar across children for a given language, with varying individual progress rates.

These stages are similar across languages.

Child language is rule-governed and systematic, not necessarily corresponding to adult rules.

Children are resistant to correction.

Processing capacity limits the number of rules they can apply at one time.

Why did SLA researchers become interested in first language acquisition principles?

Predictions from contrastive analysis did not align with actual language learning.

Differences or similarities among languages don't necessarily predict difficulty or ease.

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What is "error analysis" in second language learning, and why did it emerge?

Error analysis is the systematic investigation of SL learners' errors.

It emerged due to disillusionment with contrastive analysis and the need to understand the origin of learner errors.

Where do errors in second language learning originate, according to studies in error analysis?

Errors don't necessarily originate from the first language.

Many errors are neither target-like nor first-language-like; they must be learner-internal.

What is "inter-language," and who coined this term?

"Inter-language" refers to the language produced by learners, both as a system and as a series of interlocked systems.

The term was coined by Selinker in 1972.

What does Krashen's Monitor Model propose, and what are its five basic hypotheses?

Krashen's Monitor Model is a theory of second language acquisition.

The five basic hypotheses are:

The Acquisition-Learning hypothesis.

The Monitor hypothesis.

The Natural Order hypothesis.

The Input hypothesis.

The Affective Filter hypothesis.

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Lesson-08

SLA HYPOTHESES

Topic 045: Monitor Hypothesis

What is the main function of the learning system according to Krashen?

The main function is to act as a monitor or editor.

How does the monitor hypothesis relate to acquisition and fluency?

The monitor is responsible for making changes in the form of utterances and is thought to alter the output of the acquired system.

Why is the monitor hypothesis criticized?

It's criticized because the monitor doesn't operate all the time in real-time conversations, and its claims are difficult to test empirically.

Topic 046: Natural Order Hypothesis

What does the Natural Order Hypothesis propose?

It suggests that we acquire language rules in a predictable order that isn't solely determined by formal simplicity.

What criticism is often leveled at the Natural Order Hypothesis?

It's criticized for being too strong and for ignoring language transfer and individual variability. It relies heavily on morpheme studies, which reflect production accuracy rather than acquisition sequences.

Topic 047: Input Hypothesis

How is the Input Hypothesis related to the Natural Order Hypothesis?

The Input Hypothesis claims that learners move along the developmental continuum by receiving comprehensible input.

What does the Input Hypothesis say about the relationship between speaking and acquisition?

It states that speaking is a result of acquisition, not its cause, and speech emerges on its own as a result of building competence via comprehensible input.

What criticism is associated with the Input Hypothesis?

It's criticized for being vague and imprecise, as it lacks independently testable definitions and doesn't specify the internal workings of the "Language Acquisition Device."

What is the Input Hypothesis, and how does it relate to the Natural Order Hypothesis? How is it criticized?

The Input Hypothesis is connected to the Natural Order Hypothesis. It suggests that learners move along the developmental continuum by receiving comprehensible input, which is essential for language acquisition. According to this hypothesis, speaking is a result of acquisition, not its cause, and speech cannot be taught directly. Instead, it emerges as a consequence of building competence through comprehensible input. It further asserts that if the input is understood, the necessary grammar is automatically provided. However, the Input Hypothesis has been criticized for being vague and imprecise, as it lacks independently testable definitions and doesn't specify the internal workings of the "Language Acquisition Device" where acquisition occurs.

Topic 048: Affective Filter Hypothesis

What is the role of the Affective Filter in language acquisition?

The Affective Filter determines how receptive a learner is to input and captures the relationship between affective variables and the acquisition process.

What major criticism is directed at the Affective Filter Hypothesis?

It is criticized for being vague and atheoretical.

What is the role of the Affective Filter in second language acquisition, and how does it determine a learner's receptiveness to input? What criticisms have been raised against this hypothesis?

The Affective Filter is a concept that determines how receptive a learner is to input. It captures the relationship between affective variables and the language acquisition process. The hypothesis suggests that acquirers vary in the strength or level of their affective filter, and their attitude toward second language acquisition influences both their input and their affective filter. However, this hypothesis has faced criticism for being vague and lacking a solid theoretical foundation.

Topic 049: Schumann's Acculturation Model of SLA

How does Schumann's Acculturation Model view second language acquisition?

It views SLA as related to the degree of acculturation of learners, linking it to the complexity of pidgin language.

What are the major factors identified in acculturation according to this model?

Social distance and psychological distance are the major factors in acculturation. Social distance involves the relationship between language groups, while psychological distance relates to the psychological aspects of learning an L2.

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Lesson-09

SECOND LANGUAGE AND UNIVERSAL GRAMMAR

Topic 051 - SLA 1980s and Beyond

What happened to Second Language Acquisition (SLA) by the mid-1980s?

It matured into an autonomous field with various research programs.

What are some key areas of focus in SLA research in the 1980s?

The role of internal mechanisms, the role of the first language, psychological variables, social and environmental factors, and input.

How did Second Language Acquisition (SLA) evolve by the mid-1980s?

By the mid-1980s, Second Language Acquisition (SLA) had developed into a self-sustaining field of research with various distinct research programs, each characterized by its theoretical orientations and methodologies. This evolution was marked by the emergence of connections with cognitive science, neuro-psychology, and socio-cultural frameworks, which significantly broadened the understanding of SLA. However, it's important to note that the research agenda in SLA still centered on fundamental issues carried forward from the 1970s.

Topic 052 - Universal Grammar Approach

Who developed the Universal Grammar Approach (UG)?

Noam Chomsky developed the UG Approach.

What are the two main goals of the UG Approach in SLA research?

Descriptive adequacy and explanatory adequacy.

What is the Universal Grammar Approach (UG), and who developed it?

The Universal Grammar Approach (UG) is a theory of language acquisition developed by Noam Chomsky. This approach posits that language results from the interplay of two fundamental factors: the initial state, referred to as the 'language acquisition device,' and the ongoing experiences or 'input.' The UG Approach has dual aims: descriptive adequacy and explanatory adequacy.

Topic 053 - Aims of Linguistic Research

What are the three basic questions about human language that SLA research aims to answer?

A: 1. What constitutes knowledge of language?

2. How is knowledge of language acquired?

3. How is knowledge of language put to use?

What are the goals of linguistic theory in SLA research?

To describe the mental representations of language and define commonalities and distinctions among languages.

Topic 054 - Universal Grammar as a 'Transition Theory'

Why is Universal Grammar (UG) considered a "transition theory" in SLA?

It describes both the knowledge of language (property theory) and how that knowledge is acquired by learners (transition theory).

Who is interested in the language transition process, according to this theory?

Universal Grammar (UG) is interested in describing the language transition process during the learning of the second language.

Lesson-10

UNIVERSAL GRAMMAR AND FIRST LANGUAGE ACQUISTION

Topic 057: UG: Acquisition of Language

What is UG in the context of language acquisition?

UG stands for Universal Grammar, which is the innate language knowledge that humans possess.

Topic 058: UG: Acquisition of Language: Theoretical Scenarios

What do children do on the basis of messy input in language acquisition?

Children create mental representations of language that go beyond the input they receive.

How do second language learners differ from native speakers in terms of cognitive maturity?

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Second language learners are cognitively mature and more resourceful in problem-solving and dealing with abstract concepts.

What are some possible theoretical scenarios in language acquisition?

There are two possibilities: SL grammars are constrained by universal grammar (UG), or UG does not constrain SL grammar, or UG is impaired.

Topic 059: How is Language Put to Use? Arguments from First Language Acquisition

What does the UG approach primarily concern?

The UG approach is primarily concerned with the knowledge of language called "competence."

Topic 060: UG and First Language Acquisition

What does the notion of an innate language faculty in children suggest?

It suggests that children go through similar developmental stages in language acquisition, although the rate of progress may vary.

Is child language rule-governed and systematic?

Yes, child language is considered rule-governed and systematic.

Topic 061: Opposing Evidence

Do universalists believe there must be a specific language module in the brain?

No, universalists do not conclude that there must be a specific language module in the brain.

Is language development closely linked to intelligence?

No, language development does not seem to be closely linked to intelligence.

What is "specific language impairment"?

"Specific language impairment" is a condition in which cognitively normal children have impaired language abilities.

Can language be genetically controlled?

Some evidence suggests that at least some aspects of language might be genetically controlled.

What happens when the left hemisphere of the brain is damaged?

Damage to the left hemisphere of the brain can result in language deficits.

Are language and cognition entirely separate?

Language and cognition are not entirely separate; they do interact.

Working on the Next Lessons

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